



A PHADHAKAR RAO

LAWLESS: Afsar (centre) and Moazzam (left)

and supporters in the attack on writer Taslima Nasreen when she visited the city this August.

The doctors struck work at all government hospitals in the state for a day. They wanted the police to register an attempt-to-murder case against Afsar and his men.

State ministers Galla Aruna and M. Mukesh Goud have sought the transfer of investigation to the state Crime Branch and suspension of the sub-inspector who did not intervene. But it has not cut much ice with the angry medicos. "The legislator and his henchmen abused and assaulted us, but no action was initiated. Is this correct?" asks Andhra Pradesh Junior Doctors' Association President G. Raju, saying that the "MLA's inhuman behaviour was nothing short of an attack on the entire medical profession."

Even Chief Minister Y.S. Rajasekhara Reddy, himself a medical graduate, could not disagree.

by Amarnath K. Menon

Militant Malaise

HYDERABAD The belligerent Majlis-e-Ittehadul Muslimeen (MIM) is becoming militant by the day. Activists, led by legislator Afsar Khan, stormed the the state-run Niloufer Hospital for children and assaulted doctors, including a lady surgeon, in protest against what they considered the doctors' negligence of an activist's infant earlier in the day. A doctor had asked the baby's attendants for relevant forms for documentation of the case. Refusing to do so, the at-

tendants roughed up the doctor and left only to return with Afsar and his pack of musclemen. They allegedly manhandled six doctors, abused them and threatened to burn them alive.

The police were silent till the doctors filed a complaint against Afsar and his men, who were arrested and released on bail. Afsar and another MIM legislator, Moazzam Khan, have an unedifying record for taking law into their own hands. They had steered MIM legislators

SIGNPOSTS

CONVICTED: Mastermind in the fake stamp paper scam **Abdul Karim Telgi**, in a case related to the murder of his employee Christopher Chenappa Bhatti in August 2001.

APPOINTED: Lieutenant General **Amarjeet Singh Sekhon** as director general,



military operations. He was commander of the J&K-based 15 Corps and takes over from Lieutenant General Mohan Pande.

ELECTED: Swami **Atmasthananda**, the senior-most vice-president of Ramakrishna Math and Ramakrishna Mission, as the 15th president of the two organisations.

INCLUDED: In *The Guinness Book of World Records*, **Ajay Kumar**, Malayalam film's "little man", as the "shortest hero leading an adult role in a commercial film" for his performance in *Adbhutha Dweep* (Wonder Island).

VIS-A-VIS SONIA GANDHI UPA chairperson versus NARENDRA MODI Gujarat chief minister

In today's Gujarat, those who run the Government are liars, corrupt and peddlers of religion and death.



SAURABH SINGH

She is slinging Italian mud at me but it doesn't bother me. That kind of mud only makes me and the lotus stronger.

EPILOGUE: All work and no mudslinging would have made elections a dull affair.